



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

Uganda: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-23

Edition of 2026-08-23 · 151 systems and instruments tracked, 16 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-23 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 151 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 79 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-23, 25 did not, 31 carry no stated baseline, and 16 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 250 sources for this place in the window — 47 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 203 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Over the twelve months to 6 August 2026 the systems that moved furthest in Uganda were the ones already built. The national identity platform completed a [migration of 28,571,893 legacy records](#) and added iris capture; the data protection office carried an extraterritorial order through to [confirmed compliance](#); electronic money grew [28.6% to UGX 326tn in FY2024/25](#). Three new terrestrial fibre routes reached Kampala.

Two positions moved the other way. Social media and over-the-top messaging were [blocked around the January 2026 election and have not been restored](#), and legitimate pay-television subscriptions [fell from about 1.65 million in 2021 to about 800,000 by March 2026](#).

The instruments that did not move are as informative. Uganda's artificial-intelligence strategy was described as being in its final stages in April 2025 and was [still in drafting on 30 July 2026](#). The national backbone's utilisation figure has not been refreshed since December 2023. And sixteen rows carry no stated baseline at all, which is a fact about the record rather than about the country.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Active mobile subscriptions	45.7m active mobile subscriptions (2025-09-30)	About 47m active SIMs (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Northern Corridor regional satellite	Did not exist	Feasibility study agreed by Kenya, South Sudan, Uganda and Rwanda	ADVANCED
Paratus Goma-Mombasa route	Did not exist	In service via Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi; Uganda partner Roke Telekom	ADVANCED
Retail broadband and data price series	None published	Approximately USD 1.40/GB for mobile data, attributed by EACO to a 40% tax burden on smartphones (EACO regional dataset, data period 2024-2025); UCC separately asserts costs continue to decline without publishing a figure (2026-07-02)	ADVANCED
Savanna Fibre Uganda 1 Gbps fixed broadband	Did not exist	1 Gbps fixed broadband on sale	ADVANCED
Seacom Nairobi-Kampala route	Did not exist	1 Tbps live, scalable to 30 Tbps; border crossings at Malaba and Busia; about 13 ms to Mombasa	ADVANCED
Smartphones in use	18m (date not published)	20m (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Social media and OTT restriction	Facebook officially restricted since 2021; circumvention by VPN declared illegal	All social media and OTT messaging blocked; no lifting on record as at 2026-08-06	REGRESSED
Starlink operational licence	Unlicensed; access shut off on regulatory directive, no terminals operating at 2026-01-01	Licensed for five years on conditions — national gateway, physical point of presence, staffed local office, registration of every in-country device — and now live, with two domestic providers the first to switch the service on	ADVANCED
Bayobab Kampala-Malaba fibre route	In service, 260 km, over 1 Tbit/s (2025-05)	Unchanged; no capacity change or upgrade reported	NO CHANGE
Border free public Wi-Fi, Bwera and Mpondwe	In operation (2025-07)	No expansion, usage figure or further site on record	NO CHANGE
National Backbone Infrastructure Phase V	Utilisation under 30% of full capacity; Phase V approved (2023-12)	No delivery, utilisation or completion figure published as at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE, NO NEWER FIGURE
MTN Uganda coverage and fibre footprint	BASELINE NOT HELD	25.4m mobile subscribers and 12.6m active data subscribers (2026-06-30); 96.2% 3G, 88.6% 4G and 19% 5G population coverage and 27,037 km fibre (2025-12-31)	Baseline not held

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
ABQ Cloud sovereign cloud ecosystem	Did not exist	Operating with Roke Cloud and AfriQloud, priced in local currency, hosted in Raxio's facility	ADVANCED
Centenary Group Green Tier 3 data centre, Masaka	Completion promised late 2025 (2025-08-11)	Rebased to Q1 2026; no launch reported as at 2026-08-06	STALLED
Nxtra Africa Kampala edge site	Projection only (2024-12)	Still a projection; nothing built, dated or costed	NO CHANGE
Raxio Data Centre, Namanve	Operating (2024-08)	Operating; no Uganda capacity figure published, group committed capital rose from US\$350m to US\$380m on 2026-07-13	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Aeonian USIO supercomputer at Karuma	BASELINE NOT HELD	Planned at 10MW; nothing built and no construction start on record as at 2026-08-06	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Karuma surplus power for compute	BASELINE NOT HELD	100MW of surplus pre-transmission power from the 600MW plant, with Nile-water cooling, claimed in the project design	<i>Baseline not held</i>
MTN Uganda network sites on solar or hydro	BASELINE NOT HELD	45% of network sites on solar or hydro; a 490 kWh solar plant commissioned at headquarters	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Cyberattack volume	<i>Baseline not held</i>	A 60% year-on-year rise, including a UGX 62bn central-bank incident	REGRESSED
Legitimate pay-TV subscriptions	About 1.65m (2021)	About 800,000 (2026-03)	REGRESSED
National anti-piracy coordination framework	Did not exist	Being built with broadcasters, MTN, Airtel, Lyca, URA and URSB; no text drafted	ADVANCED
National Information Security Framework 2026	An earlier framework in force, edition and date not held (2025-08)	Updated framework issued, setting minimum controls for government institutions and critical-infrastructure protection	ADVANCED
Recorded cybercrime cases	523 cases (2023)	446 cases, UGX 72.1bn lost, an 887-case backlog (2024)	NO CHANGE, NO 2025 FIGURE PUBLISHED

The clearest twelve-month gain is international capacity Uganda did not build. The [Goma-to-Mombasa route lit in February 2026](#) and the [Nairobi–Kampala route launched in June with 1 Tbps activated](#) are both commercial builds, as is the [1 Gbps fixed-broadband product launched in May](#). The state's own backbone has no delivery, utilisation or completion figure published since Parliament recorded utilisation [under 30% of capacity in December 2023](#).

Satellite access travelled from prohibition to conditional licence inside the window: terminals were [disabled on regulatory direction in January 2026](#) and a [five-year operating licence was signed in May](#) requiring a national gateway, a local point of presence, a staffed office and registration of every device.

Data-centre capacity moved less than announcements suggest. A [sovereign cloud service opened in March 2026](#) inside an existing colocation building. A Masaka facility promised for late 2025 was [rebased to the first quarter of 2026](#) and no launch is reported. The Karuma supercomputer, announced in 2025 for a 2026 rollout start, has nothing built. No national data-centre capacity figure exists at either end of the window.

On cybersecurity the record shows an instrument replaced and an instrument struck out. The updated [national information security framework issued in July 2026](#) supersedes an earlier edition the base does not hold, and the [Constitutional Court nullified the Computer Misuse Act's principal speech offences in March](#).

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
UGHub	Used by more than 100 agencies and private entities including banks, insurers and fintechs (2024-06)	Agency integration 37%, target 73% by FY2029/30; no operational or adoption reporting held since 2024-06	NO CHANGE
UGPass	Authentication and e-signature platform; no user or transaction figures at any date	Unchanged; nothing on file since the deck	NO CHANGE

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Enhanced national ID card	2014-15 cards expiring end-2025; 100,000 enhanced cards printed (2025-07-16)	Laser-engraved cards with QR and barcode, ghost image and digital signature in all districts and diaspora issuance opened in Dubai in February 2026 – but the QR codes on newly issued cards do not work, which the registration authority acknowledged publicly on 9 February 2026 and which was raised in Parliament on 20 August; banks turning citizens away, telecoms unable to verify SIM applications, and a Shs5,000 charge for a workaround letter	ADVANCED, REGRESSED IN VERIFICATION
First-time enrolment against target	5.3m renewals against a 33m combined target; no first-time figure published (2025-07-16)	6.4m of 17.2m first-time, 37.3%; 14.3m of 15.8m renewals, 90.5%	ADVANCED
ID cards printed against collected	100,000 enhanced cards printed and ready for collection (2025-07-16)	10,152,559 printed, 7,261,435 shipped, 2,581,457 collected, 35.5%	ADVANCED
Iris capture on registration kits	Stated intent to add iris after about 1m register entries whose stored prints fail matching (2024)	Iris capture in the field; the stated reason is more than 1m Ugandans unable to register fingerprints, disproportionately elderly and manual labourers	ADVANCED
National Secure Identification System	Migration under way; five modules launched April 2025; 5.3m renewals recorded (2025-07-16)	28,571,893 legacy records migrated; five modules live; the authentication module stated operational by end-March 2026	ADVANCED
NIRA register data-breach investigation	Did not exist	Opened September 2025; no findings, sanction or independent inquiry published as at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED, NO OUTCOME
Tax identification number merged into the national ID number	Separate tax and identity numbers	The national ID number to serve as the tax number and registration-bureau numbers as business tax numbers; no passage, commencement date or completion recorded as at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
Financial institutions with e-KYC access to the register	74 institutions (2024-06)	74 institutions (2024-06); no updated count published	NO CHANGE
ISER v Attorney General and NIRA	Dismissed; s.66 found mandatory for social security, exclusion evidence held to be few and isolated cases	Unchanged; no appeal on record as at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Citizens awaiting a national identity card	Not held	17 million citizens still awaiting national identity cards as at late October 2025, with only 0.2% of first-time applicants cleared for printing, against a 26% staff vacancy rate at the registration authority and a UGX256.8bn shortfall in identity-renewal funding	BASELINE NOT HELD
NIRA staffing against approved establishment	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operating at 70% of the approved workforce, with 25 districts served by a single member of staff and two board seats vacant (2026-08-07)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Airtel Money and Britam insurance distribution	Did not exist	Motor third-party insurance sold by USSD with a digital sticker issued online; framed by the insurance regulator as narrowing the protection gap	ADVANCED
AKIBA tokenised-asset exchange	Did not exist	A regulated tokenised-asset exchange to run under the central-bank and capital-markets sandboxes; no licence, launch date or volume published	ADVANCED
Cash-withdrawal caps	Did not exist	Over-the-counter withdrawals capped at UGX 50m a day and 250m a week for individuals, UGX 500m a day and 2.5bn a week for businesses; interbank cheque limits halved	ADVANCED
Centenary and MicroPay platform memorandum	Did not exist	Intent to build school-fees saving and instalment payment with payment-history-based financing, agent-network healthcare payments and digitised insurance; no amount, launch date, user target or governance arrangement	ADVANCED
E-money transaction value	FY2023/24 value not separately held; growth reported at 28.6%	UGX 326tn in FY2024/25; agent banking UGX 29.4tn, up 76.1%, and agents 22,793, up 49.1%, while debit-card use fell 5.1% to 3.6m and internet-banking users fell 6.6% to 0.9m	ADVANCED
MTN MoMo active users	More than 10m active users, over UGX 55tn a year (2025-07-23)	14.7m active subscribers; more than 5bn transactions worth UGX 195.5tn; 241,000 active agents and 114,800 merchants	ADVANCED
Okusevinga USSD micro-investing pilot	Did not exist	USSD access to money-market and bond funds from UGX 10,000, intended to draw cash and informal savings-group money into regulated instruments; no provider, launch date or user figure published	ADVANCED
SCRIPT stablecoin settlement corridor	Did not exist	A licensed local-currency-in, stablecoin-out settlement corridor across four East African markets including Uganda; no volume or counterparty figure published	ADVANCED
Tax payment on MTN MoMo	Did not exist	Free USSD tax payment on any handset; the revenue authority collected UGX 15.25tn net in H1 FY2025/26 against a UGX 14.93tn target	ADVANCED
UnionPay e-commerce acceptance	A Standard Bank and UnionPay collaboration since 2024, with no online acceptance on record	Online acceptance open to participating merchants, settling in local currency, US dollars or both	ADVANCED
MTN MoMo separation and listing	Separation approved, a listing under consideration (2025-07-23)	Unchanged; no listing, completion or revised timetable on record as at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
National Payment Switch	In progress, no date given (2025-10-06)	Unchanged; nothing further held as at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
RTGS replacement and ISO 2022 migration	Set to go live November 2025 (2025-10-06)	Unchanged; no held source confirms or denies go-live	NO CHANGE, TARGET DATE PASSED UNVERIFIED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Digital shilling CBDC pilot	BASELINE NOT HELD	A bond-backed pilot tied to a special economic zone, financed by tokenised loans; the central bank separately records a CBDC study as planned; no pilot design, date or participant on record	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Direct yuan settlement through CIPS	Not held	A commercial bank has opened direct yuan settlement for Ugandan businesses trading with China by integrating China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System, cutting reliance on the dollar leg; Uganda imported US\$3.3bn from China in 2025 against US\$118m of exports	BASELINE NOT HELD
Mobile money platform migration to a cloud-native vendor platform	Did not exist	The dominant operator's mobile money platform moved off a legacy virtualised environment onto a cloud-native vendor fintech platform, the vendor reporting cuts of up to 86% in CPU processing and database load and up to 80% in API response times; the migration completed in Eswatini, Ghana, Rwanda and Uganda, with Cameroon under way and Benin, the Republic of the Congo and Zambia in discussion	BASELINE NOT HELD
PAPSS participation	BASELINE NOT HELD	One commercial bank live, announced by the operator with no go-live date distinct from the announcement, no corridor list, no volumes and no tariff; no held source puts the Bank of Uganda on the system as a settlement participant	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Alien registration and Alien Identification Number	Did not exist	First cards issued, with 1,875 foreigners enrolled in the ten weeks since registration opened, against about 2m registered foreigners in scope; the US\$100 card is required for SIM registration, banking and business access but confers no vote	ADVANCED
Birth registration drive	Registration system in 112 of 135 districts and 222 of 5,230 birth-handling facilities (2020); certificate holding 32% (2016)	Community drives of ten or more parents; under-nine-months exempt from biometrics; certificates free under six months then UGX 10,000, 20,000 and 50,000 by age band	ADVANCED
URSB Non-Individual Register	Did not exist	A centralised digital register for companies, partnerships, NGOs, cooperatives and community organisations, each given a unique entity registration number	ADVANCED
Marriage registration under NIRA	Births, marriages and deaths under one body (2025-04)	Unchanged	NO CHANGE
Land registry digitisation	BASELINE NOT HELD	Blockchain and AI systems planned to cut transaction fraud, plus mass titling; no procurement, budget, supplier or date	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
National Laboratory Data Repository	Did not exist	A one-stop platform linking laboratory information systems to the National Health Data Warehouse for real-time surveillance and planning	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Copyright Management System	Did not exist	In testing, with a September 2026 rollout targeted	ADVANCED
Electronic Government Procurement system	36 entities onboarded (date not published)	136 entities onboarded and Version 2.0 in service, verifying suppliers automatically against URA, URSB, NIRA and NSSF records; onboarded entities no longer advertise tenders in newspapers and may transact only with registered providers	ADVANCED
Government Procurement Portal	Publishing machine-readable procurement data, with no project-level or safeguard data	Upgrade announced with the transparency initiative and the finance ministry; no go-live, completion or published dataset recorded as at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
East African digital public infrastructure project pipeline	Baseline not held	German-funded consultancy tendered to identify and prepare bankable digital public infrastructure projects across Uganda, Kenya and Tanzania, covering digital identity, data exchange, payments and e-government; value, duration and selected consultant not stated	BASELINE NOT HELD
Human Rights Commission case-management system	Baseline not held	Launched by the national IT authority alongside the teacher-training platform, digitising the Human Rights Commission's case handling; no caseload, retention rule or data-protection assessment is published for a system holding complaint records	BASELINE NOT HELD
U-Learn teacher-training platform	Baseline not held	Launched by the national IT authority as one of two new e-services under the government network programme, with more than 6,600 teachers enrolled at launch; no curriculum, completion rate or running cost is published	BASELINE NOT HELD

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
9th Uganda National Household Survey	8th round findings released May 2025; 9th round not in field	16 language-matched field teams after fifteen days' training	ADVANCED
Labour, Employment, Productivity and Reporting Programme	Did not exist	An integrated administrative labour-data ecosystem under the Employment Act, against official figures of 12.3% unemployment, 42% labour underutilisation and 88% informality	ADVANCED
Statistics House Entebbe office block	Did not exist	Under construction by a domestic contractor at a stated sh76bn, government-funded and due within three years, to house a data centre, data science hub, statistics innovation hub, training centre and offices coordinating censuses and surveys, with conference halls and high-security data vaults; the finance minister pledged on 6 August to engage East African Community partner states on siting the regional statistics bureau at it	ADVANCED

Identity is where the twelve months are best measured, and the two halves of the register moved at very different speeds. Renewals reached 14.3m of a 15.8m target, 90.5%, against first-time enrolment of 6.4m of 17.2m, 37.3%. Card production ran ahead of collection: 10,152,559 printed and 2,581,457 collected. Iris capture was deployed on more than 5,665 registration kits because more than a million people cannot register fingerprints, disproportionately the elderly and manual labourers.

The registry layer added three objects that did not exist a year ago: a [non-individual register](#), [alien registration](#) and a [birth-registration drive with a published fee schedule](#).

Payments grew and diversified. Alongside the [28.6% rise in electronic money](#), agent banking rose 76.1% and agent numbers 49.1%, while debit-card use fell 5.1% and internet-banking users 6.6%. The largest mobile-money operator reported [14.7 million active subscribers and more than 5 billion transactions worth UGX 195.5tn](#) for the year to December 2025; its separation into a distinct financial company, approved by shareholders in July 2025, has [not completed](#) and carries no revised timetable.

Two public rails did not move at all. The real-time settlement replacement was stated for a November 2025 go-live and no held source confirms or denies it; the national payment switch has been in progress since October 2025 with nothing further.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Computer Misuse Act ss.11, 23, 26-29	In force and the state's main tools for prosecuting online speech (2025-08)	Struck down, together with Penal Code ss.162-163 on criminal libel	REGRESSED
Digital lending platform regulation	Did not exist	The microfinance minister told a Kampala retreat that government is moving to close regulatory gaps around digital lending platforms, set against financial inclusion of 81 per cent (2023) from 70 per cent (2009) and an 85 per cent target for 2028 under the second national financial inclusion strategy	ADVANCED
Protection of Sovereignty Bill, 2026	Not on file (2025-08)	Before joint parliamentary committees in April 2026; described as recently enacted on 2026-08-02, with no assent date, gazette notice or text held	ADVANCED
Telecom-infrastructure vandalism enforcement	No convictions on file (2025-08)	A five-year sentence for mast vandalism in Kibaale, USh23.6m of damage, and a one-year sentence for a SIM-registration breach	ADVANCED
UCC enforcement against unlicensed public Wi-Fi	Did not exist (2025-08)	Nationwide campaign under way; unlicensed operators told to regularise or cease; no count of operators actioned	ADVANCED
UCC order suspending public internet	No shutdown order in force (2025-08)	Connectivity cut from 18:00 local (15:00 UTC) 2026-01-13 and restored 23:00 local (20:00 UTC) 2026-01-17 — 4 days 5 hours by measurement; UCC announced restoration from midnight 2026-01-18 with social media and OTT apps still blocked; full restoration announced 2026-01-26, 13 days after the order. The Uganda Law Society called it unlawful for want of a state of emergency; the directives were ordered tabled on 2026-03-10	ADVANCED

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
NITA-U Strategic Plan FY2025/26 to FY2029/30	Did not exist (2025-08)	Six objectives with targets: e-government use 9.2% to 40%, UGHub coverage of agencies 37% to 73%, national data-centre utilisation 70% to 83%, IT-law compliance 67% to 81% by FY2029/30	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
UCC telecom taxation reform proposals	Did not exist (2025-08)	Excise duty on data and airtime 12% to 5%, VAT on mobile data 18% to 14%, duty relief on entry-level 4G and 5G handsets; the ICT ministry states a device-tax-cut paper is ready for cabinet before the end of the quarter, and no measure is adopted	ADVANCED

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Uganda's seat on the ATU Administrative Council	No Council seat on file (2025-08)	One of 25 member states in the Eastern Africa group; Uganda's floor intervention was on implementation reporting under the Union's risk-management framework	ADVANCED
Harmonised EAC framework for AI and digital-finance regulation	BASELINE NOT HELD	A chair's position only, with no instrument, drafting mandate or date; a regional AI policy roadmap was floated in March 2026	Baseline not held

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Government Enterprise Architecture and e-GIF	The 2021 architecture and framework at their five-year mark, renewal not begun (2025-08)	Renewed documents delivered with the e-Governance Academy and World Bank support; rollout not reported	ADVANCED
National Monitoring and Evaluation System reporting quality	BASELINE NOT HELD	Gaps and inconsistencies across agency submissions; the remedy is a working-group meeting and a request for consolidated annual performance reports; no error rate, vote count or remediation date	Baseline not held

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Beera Ku Guard awareness campaign	Did not exist (2025-08)	Campaign run; no outcome published against either target as at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
Data Protection and Privacy Act, Cap 97	One extraterritorial ruling issued, compliance untested (2025-07-18)	Five corrective orders implemented by a foreign controller with the appeal window expired unused and no fine, against a registration base in which only 14,697 data controllers and processors are compliant out of an estimated 50,000 entities that collect or process personal data – more than 35,000 unregistered – with the office pursuing defaulters through the courts, the criminal investigations directorate and the prosecutions directorate	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Data Sharing Agreement under the health memorandum	Did not exist	Provided for in the memorandum and not on record as executed: capped at seven years from the memorandum's execution, five over its course and two for reporting, governed jointly by the Joint Health Steering Committee with the Government of Uganda as data owner, requiring prior written authorisation, and binding all data activities to the Data Protection and Privacy Act Cap 97 and the National Data Governance Framework; the State Department briefly posted a subset of the memoranda in March 2026, then removed access and published none of the related agreements, and a suit for their release was unresolved at 2026-04-02. A rights organisation's reading of the seven signed memoranda puts Uganda among five whose text requires unilateral sharing of specimens and pathogen-sequencing data, and all seven as requiring broad audit access	ADVANCED
PDPO decision in AdLegal v WhatsApp and Meta	No decision on file (2025-08)	Five orders complied with inside the 90-day timelines; impact assessment, adequacy assessment, legitimate-interests assessment and a Uganda-specific privacy notice delivered; no appeal, no fine	ADVANCED
PDPO orders against Google LLC	Orders issued, the 30-day clock running (2025-07-18)	No record of registration, a data-protection officer contact or a transfer-framework filing as at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
Be a Cyber Hero child online-safety campaign	Baseline not held	A three-year campaign on child online safety launched in Kampala, led by the ICT ministry with the communications regulator and a private partner; no budget, reach target or evaluation arrangement is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
Public grasp of data-protection principles	BASELINE NOT HELD	13.6% grasp data-protection principles (2025-12)	Baseline not held

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Fourth-cycle Universal Periodic Review	Third-cycle review concluded January 2022 with 273 recommendations, 139 supported and 134 noted; no fourth-cycle submission on file (2025-08)	Joint submission by CIPESA, APC and WOUGNET filed, seeking repeal of the Computer Misuse Act speech offences, a statutory bar on network disruption, removal of the 12% excise duty on internet data, and statutory independence and fining powers for the Personal Data Protection Office; the review had not been held as at 2026-08-07	ADVANCED
Judiciary media guidelines issued through ECCMIS	Did not exist (2025-08)	Prior accreditation required, devices barred from the courtroom, live broadcasting granted case by case; the Law Society asked for the restrictions to be lifted	ADVANCED
URA e-Tax2 award	Technical evaluation notice displayed 2025-08-25, under challenge	Award set aside by the Appeals Tribunal on a power-of-attorney defect, the capacity objection struck out unadjudicated; none of 26 commercial banks would issue the guarantee gating the 15% advance; joint-venture staff on the revenue authority's premises since January with no work started	STALLED

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
EU Delegation funding for a sovereign DPI loan package	Did not exist (2025-08)	Work with the Ministry of ICT and National Guidance; no amount, instrument or date stated	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
EU-EAC DPI Acceleration Mechanism technical assistance	The DEEP programme running since June 2025, no technical-assistance contract let (2025-08)	Estimated EUR 938,170 over 30 months from 2026-09-15, performed from the EAC office in Arusha; designs tested against the Universal DPI Safeguards Framework and local data-protection and localisation law	ADVANCED

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Procurement portal conformance with the infrastructure data standard	BASELINE NOT HELD	26 of 148 data elements published, 17.6%, and 4.2% of required project-level disclosure paths (2025-11)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Three things changed the governance position, and only one of them was a new instrument.

The first was judicial. In [March 2026 the Constitutional Court struck down the Computer Misuse Act's sections 11, 23 and 26 to 29 together with criminal libel](#), on quorum grounds and for vagueness.

The second was demonstrated capability. Twelve months ago the data protection office had issued [orders against one foreign controller with the compliance clock running](#); that compliance has never been recorded. In the window it decided a second complaint and [confirmed all five orders implemented on 17 July 2026](#) without an appeal. The same office has issued nothing on the personal-data processing that ran through the January 2026 election.

The third was administrative. A [five-year agency strategy](#) put numbers on e-government use, service-bus coverage and IT-law compliance for the first time, and the [government enterprise architecture and interoperability framework were renewed in May 2026](#) at their five-year mark; neither renewed document is held and no rollout is reported.

Against those, the pre-election shutdown directives ordered [tabled to Parliament in March 2026](#) are not on record as tabled, and the [revenue authority's core tax-system procurement](#) has moved from a contested award to joint-venture staff on site with no work started.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Ministry of ICT AI Secretariat	Did not exist	In place, laying groundwork for agriculture, health diagnostics, education and public administration	ADVANCED
National AI Research Cloud	Did not exist	Local compute and storage for training models; no capacity, cost or user figure published	ADVANCED
Policy to regulate AI and social media	Did not exist (2025-08)	The announcement is the whole of the evidence: no scope, drafting stage, responsible body, consultation route or timetable	ADVANCED
Sunflower 14B and 32B language models	Did not exist	Two models built on Qwen 3 covering 31 Ugandan languages, stated state of the art on translation in 24 of them; trained partly on more than 500 hours of digitised radio and archival text with Makerere University and community partners	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
National AI and Emerging Technologies Strategy	In the final stages per the ICT state minister (2025-04-05), no text published	Still drafting sixteen months on; no text or gazette record, and a completion date of the end of the financial year first stated on 2026-08-04	NO CHANGE
Directive on artificial intelligence in medical curricula	Not held	The medical and dental practitioners council has directed medical and dental training schools to integrate artificial intelligence into their curricula, with compliance assessed at future biennial institutional inspections	BASELINE NOT HELD
EAC regional AI policy roadmap	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under discussion as a harmonised regional roadmap; no adopted text or date	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Inclusive AI curriculum	BASELINE NOT HELD	No curriculum published and no rollout date as at 2026-08-06	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Sunflower multilingual language model	BASELINE NOT HELD	A 31-language model built by a Ugandan developer on a Chinese open-weight model, chosen over American alternatives largely on cost	<i>Baseline not held</i>

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
YAS acquisition of Wananchi Group	Wananchi Group independent	99.63% held by YAS for about US\$63m	ADVANCED

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Fintech Fridays Uganda Edition	Did not exist	A recurring convening platform; no funding, cohort or target attached	ADVANCED
Mbale ICT Hub	Did not exist	A UGX 3bn hub for young women's ICT and entrepreneurship careers; no opening date held	ADVANCED
Uganda National Innovator Registry	Did not exist	Applications closed 2026-06-01 and a prototype showcase was held 2026-06-25; gazettelement unconfirmed as at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED, GAZETEMENT UNCONFIRMED
Ugandan startups raising disclosed funding	2 startups, US\$2.4m (2024)	4 startups, US\$5.5m (2025)	ADVANCED
Startup three-year income-tax exemption	Proposed, not enacted (2025-08)	Still no record of enactment as at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
Regional ICT innovation hubs	BASELINE NOT HELD	Hubs operating at Nakawa, Soroti, Kabale and Muni, with Gulu, Busitema and Fort Portal stated to be under development (2026-08-04)	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Ugandan startups with a female co-founder	BASELINE NOT HELD	25% (2026), second to Zambia's 29%	<i>Baseline not held</i>
UICT innovation commercialisation	BASELINE NOT HELD	A two-week inventory of software ready for commercialisation instructed and a review workshop planned; no budget, legal instrument or funding line	<i>Baseline not held</i>
UJ Connect entrepreneurship programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	83 student innovators in batch four; the project is closing with no cumulative startup, funding or job figure published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
United States health-data access agreement	Did not exist	The signed memorandum caps the data-sharing arrangement at seven years from execution, places it under joint steering-committee governance with the Government of Uganda as data owner, requires prior written authorisation through a Data Sharing Agreement approved by both, binds all data activities to the Data Protection and Privacy Act Cap 97 and the National Data Governance Framework, and has Uganda approve the national health information architecture before any United States-financed investment; planned United States support is US\$1,719,960,000 against Uganda's US\$577,001,796, including US\$113,102,289 for data systems. The MOU only provides for a future Data Sharing Agreement (§2.5.2); ProPublica reported 2026-07-23 that it reviewed that agreement directly and that it grants direct, real-time login access to nine of Uganda's health data systems for seven years, a term matching the MOU's own cap. The agreement's text is unpublished and not held, and no Ugandan or US primary has confirmed or denied ProPublica's account (reconciled 2026-08-10) Eight United States senators wrote to the Secretary of State in the week to 2026-08-19 challenging the arrangement, noting that the Uganda agreement provides up to US\$1.7bn in aid for HIV, tuberculosis and malaria among other diseases against direct access to the government's own health data systems, and requesting a briefing and a written answer by the end of August 2026.	ADVANCED

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Centenary Group and Huawei banking partnership	Did not exist	AI-powered banking, cloud, cybersecurity, data management, data-centre development, staff training and joint research	ADVANCED
ICT ministry AI-skills memorandum with China exchange	Did not exist	In place for AI labs, youth skills and a China exchange on smart agriculture; no lab, cohort or disbursement recorded	ADVANCED

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Tahaluf national ID system contract	BASELINE NOT HELD	A UAE-based supplier is service provider for the new national ID system, with five modules in service	Baseline not held

The section's defining fact over twelve months is an absence that held. The artificial-intelligence strategy was described as being in its final stages in April 2025 and is still in drafting, with no text, adoption date or gazette record. What was added around it is institutional rather than normative: a secretariat inside the ICT ministry, a national research cloud at Makerere, and on 2 August 2026 the announcement of a separate policy covering artificial intelligence and social media together.

Disclosed startup funding rose from two companies raising US\$2.4m in 2024 to four raising US\$5.5m in 2025 — movement on a small base, from a tracker counting disclosed rounds only.

The largest change in the country's external technology relationships was not commercial and was not reported domestically for seven months. An agreement of 10 December 2025 grants the United States [direct, real-time access to nine national health data systems for seven years](#) against up to US\$1.7bn over five years; its text is unpublished and its existence entered the Ugandan record in July 2026.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
American-funded digital inclusion and connectivity programming	In delivery	Planned and running work slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down, with no replacement funder named	REGRESSED
Digital for Girls and Women Uganda	Active; EUR 2.25m, 2021-2025	The record still reads active; the stated period has elapsed with no closure, extension or results record held	NO CHANGE
Uganda Communications Universal Service and Access Fund	Operating; Q3 2025 outputs were 3,000 riders skilled, 4,900 tablets, laboratories in 70 secondary schools and 60 public access centres	Operating; cumulative reach stated as laboratories in more than 1,000 public secondary schools	NO CHANGE

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Average monthly consumer data spend	UGX 10,392 for 5.1GB a month (June 2025)	UGX 10,841 a month, 71 per cent of a UGX 15,349 total telecom bill and the first quarter in which data was the dominant line item, on average consumption of 3.7GB a month, up from 3.0GB in Q1 2026	ADVANCED
Gulu Service Uganda Centre	Did not exist	Under construction with more than 40 workstations; stated completion June 2026, nothing on record as delivered at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Kasese ICT hub for persons with disabilities	Did not exist	Operating; computer-literacy training, vocational skills and digital-empowerment programmes, open to the wider community	ADVANCED
Service Uganda Centres	One operational, stated on 2026-03-13 to have been the only site for three years	Six of nineteen operational; Tororo inspected, not opened; throughput made contingent on the backbone's fifth phase	ADVANCED
Connect Rural Uganda digital inclusion	Active; US\$15m running to 2026	Unchanged; stated end year 2026 with no closure or results record held	NO CHANGE
National Financial Inclusion Strategy 2023-2028	In force; priority groups widened to add refugees and persons with disabilities	In force; no mid-term review, indicator update or progress report held	NO CHANGE
Buy-now-pay-later smartphone financing	Not held	Financing schemes run by five providers put smartphones in the hands of more than 500,000 Ugandans in a year, against regulator and industry data showing about 22% of Ugandans using mobile internet despite 96% network coverage; financed devices can cost 30 to 50% more than the cash price	BASELINE NOT HELD

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Beera Ku Digital skilling programme	3,000 riders onboarded, Q3 2025	Unchanged; no output figure published since Q3 2025	NO CHANGE

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Judicial training on digital crime and evidence	Did not exist	A three-day course for judges and magistrates on cybercrime, digital evidence and deepfakes, run with the communications regulator	ADVANCED
Young Africa Works in Uganda	US\$200m commitment; a target of 4.3m young Ugandans in dignified work by 2030	Unchanged; no progress, disbursement or beneficiary figure published in the window	NO CHANGE
UICT training output	BASELINE NOT HELD	48,448 people trained in FY2025/26: 36,332 citizens, 1,932 government officers, 1,207 educators and TVET instructors and 8,977 in immersive and emerging-technology skills, with 65 certified trainers produced and 21 augmented and virtual reality courses built	Baseline not held

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
KOICA distance-education project, Makerere University	Commitment recorded; US\$12.2m, 2025-2030	Unchanged; no progress or delivery figure published	NO CHANGE

One-stop service delivery advanced on the government's own July 2026 account from [one operational centre](#) to [six of nineteen](#), although the two held accounts disagree on the early-2026 count. A [Gulu centre](#) begun in [March 2026](#) with a stated June completion has nothing on record as delivered.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Uganda Digital Acceleration Project	Active; free public Wi-Fi launched under it at the DRC border (2025-07-13)	Active; funding the Tororo, Mbarara and Gulu pilots, and named as the affordable-connectivity vehicle	NO CHANGE

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-23	MOVEMENT
Ethio Telecom cooperation talks	Not held	Preliminary: a ministerial delegation visited the Ethiopian incumbent's headquarters to explore cooperation on telecommunications infrastructure, digital payments, skills training and technology transfer in support of the national vision and the 2023-2027 digital roadmap; no agreement was signed	BASELINE NOT HELD

The universal service fund's position is unchanged in substance and better documented in fact: the regulator stated in August 2026 that [only half the statutory 2% levy is retained by the fund](#), the rest going to the Consolidated Fund. No balance or annual total has ever been published.

The three largest tracked external-financing commitments in the inclusion and capacity portfolio — a [US\\$200m ten-year skills programme](#) (Young Africa Works in Uganda), a [US\\$15m rural digital-inclusion facility running to 2026](#) (Connect Rural Uganda) and a [EUR 2.25m gender-and-skills project whose stated period has elapsed](#) (Digital for Girls and Women Uganda) — carry no progress, disbursement or closure record inside the window.

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Spectrum assignment and 5G licensing	a UCC spectrum award notice or a National Radio Frequency Plan	not yet probed
National data-centre installed capacity	a UCC or NITA-U facility register with MW or rack counts	not yet probed
Grid power at national backbone sites	a NITA-U or energy-ministry statement of how many backbone points of presence are grid-connected	not yet probed
National ICT and cybersecurity workforce baseline	a UCC or NITA-U ICT skills survey, or a named certified-professional count	not yet probed
National computer emergency response team	the National Information Security Framework 2026 text, which should name the incident-response body and the reporting duty	not yet probed
PDPO action on election-period personal-data processing	any data-protection decision, complaint-register entry or public statement on the January 2026 electoral processing	not yet probed
EU-Uganda bilateral digital cooperation instrument	a Global Gateway country package, an EU-Uganda digital memorandum, or a financing agreement naming Uganda	not yet probed
National open government data policy or portal	a named Ugandan open-data policy, a national data portal with a publication schedule, or a dataset-release instrument	not yet probed
Uganda ICT sector output and employment series	a statistics-bureau or UCC sector statistic, or the ICT ministry's development-plan sector targets	not yet probed
India-Uganda technology relationship	a named India-Uganda instrument - a line of credit, a training agreement or a supplier contract with a value	not yet probed
National Population and Housing Census 2024 final report	a text-extractable copy of the 2024 census final report volume 1, whose body is currently scanned imagery	not yet probed
Ugandan satellite or Earth-observation programme	a regional-satellite feasibility contract or cost share, or a Ugandan entry in a named continental launch programme	not yet probed
Rural DPI service delivery programme	a named last-mile programme with a target - a district-office expansion plan with a costed establishment, or a universal-fund award with a rural service line and a beneficiary count	not yet probed
Subnational digital service systems	a district or municipal system with a dated statement of what it does and how many people use it	not yet probed
National digital-literacy rate	a statistics-bureau or UCC household ICT survey reporting a digital-literacy or digital-skills rate	not yet probed
Domestic state digital-transformation budget	a finance-ministry approved estimates or ministerial policy statement volume carrying the vote lines for the ICT ministry, NITA-U and UCC	not yet probed

Seventeen rows are *Not held* at both ends of this period, so no movement can be stated for any of them. The count itself has not been reduced during the window: none of these gaps was closed by a source arriving in the twelve months.

The most consequential for a comparison of this kind is the absence of a domestic state digital budget. Without it, nothing here can be set against what Uganda appropriated, released or spent, and every state figure in this report is an announcement rather than an execution.

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.